

146 BCE

DESTRUCTION OF CARTHAGE

After the Carthaginians attacked neighbouring Numidia, a Roman army led by the consul Scipio Aemilianus landed in North Africa, blockaded Carthage, and finally took it after a year-long siege. Scipio destroyed the city and sold its people into slavery, ending the 120-year Punic Wars.

▷ Ruins of Carthage, Tunisia



146 BCE The Romans destroy Corinth and annexe Greece to the province of Macedonia

138 BCE China's Han emperor Wu sends out an envoy, Zhang Qian, whose findings usher in an era of westward expansion

101 BCE

▽ Serpent Burial Mound Ohio, USA

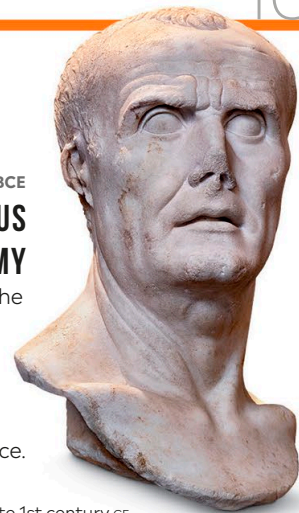


104 BCE

GENERAL GAIUS MARIUS REFORMS THE ROMAN ARMY

Marius allowed the landless poor to join the army, organizing it into cohorts (of around 480 men) and legions (of around 5,500).

With their regular weapons – the *pilum* (javelin) and *gladius* (short-sword) – the new legions were a formidable force.



▷ Portrait of Gaius Marius, late 1st century CE

“Men who were fond of toil ... without a murmur, were called Marius’s mules.”

PLUTARCH, LIFE OF MARIUS, c. 110 CE